PROactive PRONUNCIATION

V vs. W Minimal Pair Words

/w/ and /v/ are oftentimes confused. The /w/ is produced when the lips are in a rounded position, similar to “oooo." The /v/, on the other hand, includes biting the lower lip. Both are voiced. Try to compare the difference in pronunciation between these sounds in the words below. Look in the mirror to see how the shape of your lips for /w/ is round and how your upper teeth should be visible for the /v/ sound.

V	we
vary	wary
veil	whale
vein	wane
vent	went
verse	worse
versed	worst
vest	west
vet	wet
Vicks	wicks
vie	why
vile	while
vine	wine/whine
volley	Wally
vow	wow
V's	wheeze